

Colophon

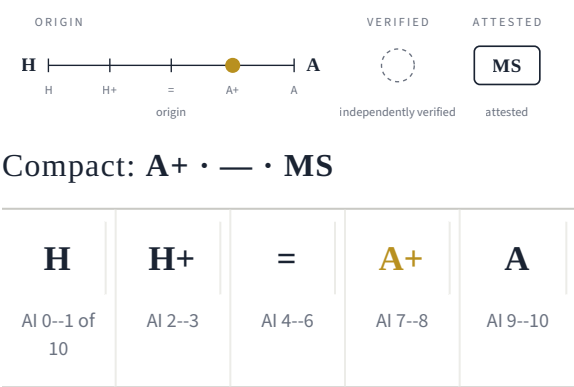
The note at the back of the book that says how it was made. Ours says who did what -- person or model -- on anything we publish.

Spec v0.3 · draft · 2026-09-09 · Deliverable 1 of 4 · Tags: SETTLED = agreed in the pilot thread INFERRED = my read, confirm OPEN = your call

§1 THE ONE-MINUTE VERSION

- **The problem.** "Did AI touch this?" is the wrong question. Lamar's 1--5 level is a better question with an unfalsifiable answer: one number carrying two facts (who originated, who's accountable).
- **Our answer.** Break the work into eleven stages, each with one verb. Each stage line names one actor -- a person or a model. Three of those facts carry all the trust: **who originated, who verified, who signed.**
- **What the reader sees.** A three-token mark on the piece (§2). Behind it, the full ledger on a standing "How This Is Made" page (§5).
- **What it costs.** About five minutes per piece once the ledger is habit. The model drafts the ledger; the human corrects and signs it.
- **What it isn't.** A grade. A+ isn't worse than H+. The dial says what kind of thing this is; the seals say whether to trust it.

§2 THE MARK



Compact: A+ · — · MS

- **Origin dial.** Five stops, H to A. Position = how many of the ten scored stages a model originated. Symmetric poles, neutral center, no good end. This is Lamar's axis, kept and demoted to composition -- like cacao percentage. SETTLED
- **Verified seal.** Gold check only when someone other than the drafter traced the facts to source. Dashed empty slot = self-checked; honest, slightly uncomfortable. "n/a" = nothing factual to check. SETTLED
- **Attested seal.** Initials of the editor of record, or nothing. Authority isn't a level in this system; it's whoever's name sits here. SETTLED
- **Discipline.** Ink and gold only, never green or red. No "assisted" or "driven" -- those smuggle a hierarchy. The only binary marks are process facts, not quality claims. SETTLED
- **Dial bands.** The 0--10 → stop mapping at left. Places the three specimens correctly (8--2 → A+, 4--6 → =, Law No. 54 → H+).

INFERRED

§3 THE ELEVEN STAGES

One verb per stage. One name per line. Situating fires twice, so eleven stages make twelve lines. Order below is the working pipeline; stages can fire out of order or not at all. **SETTLED** Placement of the two situating firings: **INFERRED**

	STAGE · VERB	THE LINE GOES TO WHOEVER...	NOT THIS STAGE
1	Ideation <i>conceived</i>	Said this piece should exist. First utterance, dated.	Agreeing it's a good idea.
2	Exploration <i>explored</i>	Surveyed the space before a direction was picked: what exists, what could be said.	Reading a summary of the options.
3	Situating I <i>situated</i>	Placed the question in the world: who it's for, what exists already, why now, what it must not be.	Restating the brief.
4	Angle <i>framed</i>	Chose the thesis and the structure that carries it (scenario tree, not narrative).	Picking among offered angles without adding one.
5	Research <i>gathered</i>	Found and selected the sources and data. Decided what's in and out of evidence.	Consuming search results without opening sources.
6	Judgment <i>called</i>	Made the calls under uncertainty: the probabilities, the recommendation, what to leave out.	Ratifying a call already made.
7	Message / Voice <i>voiced</i>	Wrote the words as they read: register, cadence, asked vs. asserted. If a model voiced it in your register, disclosure duty concentrates here.	Tone instructions ("make it warmer").
8	Refinement <i>refined</i>	Made substantive changes after the draft existed: cut, reordered, reversed a claim. Stark's edit wins.	Typo fixes. Accepting suggestions.
9	Verification <i>verified</i>	Traced every factual claim to source -- and was not the actor on lines 5--7. Produces the seal.	The drafter reading it over. "Are you sure?"
10	Attestation <i>attested</i>	Signed and dated the ledger as editor of record. Always a person. Not scored.	A role, an org, or a model as signer.
11	Situating II <i>situated</i>	Placed the finished work in the world: channel, audience, links, what it's walled off from (the 506(b) wall), its mark.	Hitting send.
12	Reckoning <i>reckoned</i>	Graded the piece's own prior claims against what happened, in public. Fires after publication. Not scored at publication.	A private post-mortem. Quiet corrections.

§4 RULES

- **Ten scored lines.** Attestation is always a person; reckoning hasn't happened yet. Both sit out. That's why the ledgers read 8--2 and 4--6. INFERRED
- **Written AI--H.** 8--2 = eight lines to a model, two to a person. When the first number climbs across issues with the seals constant, that's earned delegation. INFERRED
- **Origination decides the line.** Heavy edits to a model draft don't flip the voice line; they earn the refinement line. Sequence lives in the stage order, not in a mark. SETTLED
- **Verification is never the drafter.** A self-check is refinement. No seal. SETTLED
- **Human claims need a dated artifact.** No artifact, the line goes to the model. Memory is not evidence. WGA's burden of proof, pointed at ourselves. INFERRED
- **Voice fidelity and disclosure duty scale together.** The better the model sounds like me, the more I owe the reader. SETTLED
- **The ratio is a phase indicator, not a virtue.** No end of the dial is the right end. SETTLED
- **The reckoning record licenses high-AI work.** A public scorecard of prior calls is what earns the right to publish at A+ and A. SETTLED
- **One name, absolute.** If two parties both originated a stage, the stage boundary is wrong, not the rule. OPEN

§5 WORKED EXAMPLE -- FED WATCH CARD V2A

Reconstructed from the thread; actors and dates are placeholders until deliverable 4 rebuilds it from dated turns. The thread's own count is 8--2. By these rules I get 5--3 on eight fired lines -- same stop, different count. Worth reconciling. INFERRED

#	stage	verb	actor	evidence
01	ideation	conceived	MS	chat 09-05: "should I publish these?"
02	exploration	explored	Claude	format survey 09-05 (no public precedent)
03	situating I	situated	MS	audience: friends-and-family; wall from fund
04	angle	framed	Claude	scenario tree + family brief, v1 09-06
05	research	gathered	Claude	BLS, CME FedWatch, named press; links in card
06	judgment	called	Claude	probabilities in tree v2; MS did not override
07	message/voice	voiced	Claude	v2 prose in MS register -- disclosure duty high
08	refinement	refined	MS	redirects 09-06/07 (dated turns)
09	verification	verified	—	self-checked by drafter: no seal
10	attestation	attested	MS	09-08 (unscored)
11	situating II	situated	Claude	badge placement, v2a assembly
12	reckoning	reckoned	—	pending: post-FOMC scorecard 09-19

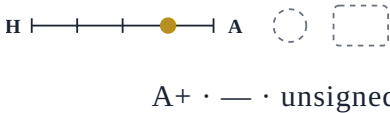
5--3 on eight fired → A+ · — · MS

- **Lamar (the foil).** Right instincts: a spectrum, disclosure not judgment. Stops short: one axis carrying two facts; measures input, not reliability; whole-document label flattens mixed work; no name attached. The Fed card is Level 4 by provenance and Level 3 by control -- both true, which is the bug. We keep his axis as token 1 and add the two tokens that carry trust.
- **WGA credits (prior art).** Exclusion by threshold, arbitration on dispute, dated drafts as the only evidence, "&" vs "and." Took: the evidence standard and credit that resolves to a decision. Left: rationing. A model can't be arbitrated out of existence; the reader still needs to know it was there. Exclusion vs disclosure is the whole fork.
- **CRediT (adjacent).** Fourteen contributor roles for scholarly authorship. Closest cousin. Missing: a machine actor, an order, evidence, verifier independence, and anything like reckoning.
- **C2PA (adjacent).** Signed manifests recording what happened to a file; icon on the asset, manifest behind it. Complementary: C2PA proves what happened to a file, Colophon says who exercised judgment. We borrow icon-plus-manifest (mark plus standing page), skip the cryptography.
- **Sheridan--Verplanck (not borrowed).** Allocates decision authority by level. Here authority isn't a level; it's the name in token three.

§7 NEXT

- **Your call on the three inferred items:** ten scored lines / AI--H order / situating placement. Then this goes to v1.0.
- **Deliverable 2, badge kit.** Specimen sheet exists. Remaining: SVG per stop and seal state, placement rule (bottom-right), link target.
- **Deliverable 3, "How This Is Made" template.** Doctrine, twelve-line ledger per issue, evidence links, models named, reckoning log, corrections policy.
- **Deliverable 4, worked examples.** The Fed card ledger rebuilt from dated turns; the hypothetical 4--6 deep-dive at = · V✓ · MS.

Colophon for this page. 01 ideation **MS** (handoff A, 09-08) · 02 exploration Claude (Q2 analysis, pilot thread) · 03 situating I **MS** ("better Lamar"; WGA, CRediT, C2PA named in brief) · 04 angle Claude (three tokens, pilot thread) · 05 research Claude (joshlamar.com fetched; prior art from model knowledge, unverified) · 06 judgment Claude (doctrine as written in pilot thread; MS accepted) · 07 message/voice Claude in MS register per voice profile 08-27 -- disclosure duty high · 08 refinement **MS** (v0.2 → v0.3 redirect, 09-09) · 09 verification — · 10 attestation unsigned · 11 situating II — · 12 reckoning —. 5--3 on eight fired. Draft, not a colophon.



MS